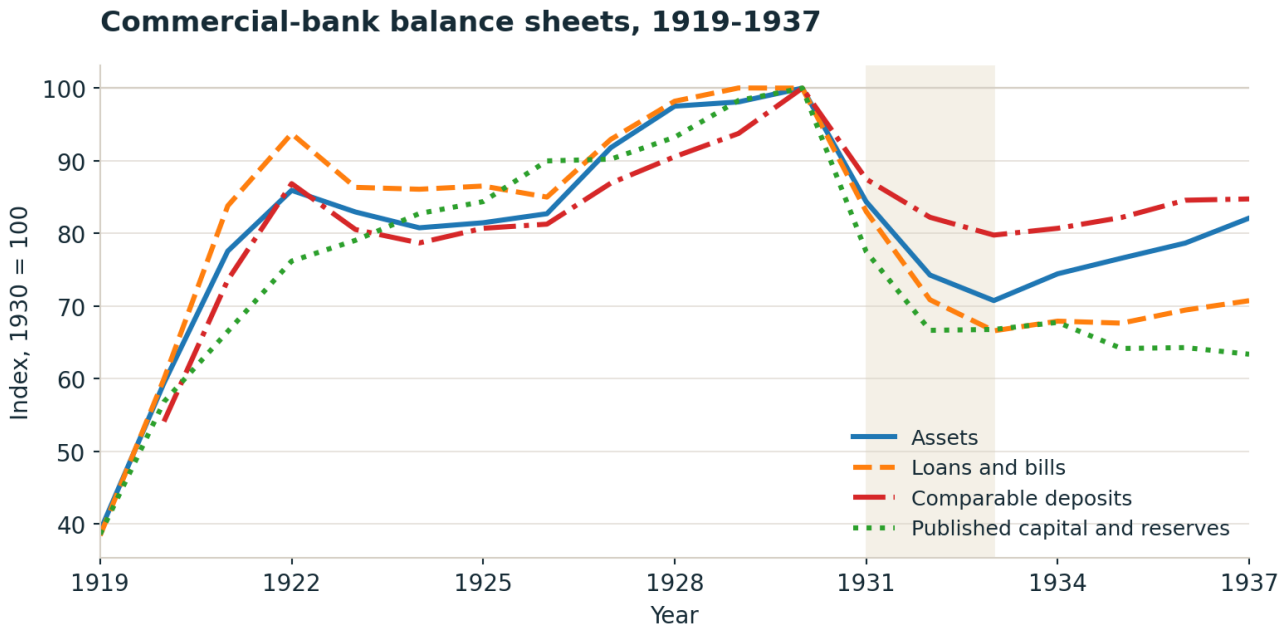
Czechoslovak Commercial Banking

1919-1937 | Joint-stock banks in the Czech lands

A research dataset by Adam Dittrich
Version 0.1.1 | Released 1 November 2026

Annual accounts, named banks and the sources behind the numbers. This release combines downloadable research tables with an Excel edition and an interactive dataset page.

Annual commercial accounts	Named-bank panel	National roster
19 years 1919-1937	14 banks, 70 bank-years 1933-1937	22 institutions 1929 crosswalk



Changing aggregate of joint-stock banks in the Czech lands. Deposits begin in 1920.
Source: League of Nations banking volumes; frozen observations in this release.

The annual series follows a changing population of banks. The named-bank panel follows the same fourteen institutions. Their observations retain distinct definitions and source identifiers.

Explore first, then download

Open **index.html** for the standalone dataset page or the **Excel workbook** for a tabular view. The complete archive includes the CSV data, source dictionary, frozen inputs and reconstruction code.

What the release contains

The core tables cover commercial banking. National Bank and price observations are separate context, with their own coverage.

Files in data/	Coverage and content
annual_aggregate.csv	19 annual rows. Principal assets, funding, income, reporting counts and comparability flags.
annual_balance_sheet.csv annual_income.csv annual_components.csv	Full source-oriented annual detail: assets, liabilities, expenditure, write-offs, profit appropriation, cash and lending components.
annual_ratios.csv	Capital, lending and funding shares; income intensities; annual growth; indices with 1930 = 100.
bank_panel.csv bank_ratios.csv	70 observations with stable bank identifiers, original category notes, source pages, ratios and indices with 1933 = 100.
institution_crosswalk_1929.csv coverage_1929.csv	22 national institutions, fourteen later-panel matches, omitted cases and dated coverage measures.
central_bank_context.csv price_context.csv	Nine National Bank years, 1929-1937. CPI values from 1923 and available WPI observations with explicit timing and gaps.
reserve_events.csv	Dated reserve and stabilisation transactions, with their accounting meanings.
observations_long.csv source_observations.csv	Tidy analytical records and the separate selected-source ledger, with original publication identifiers, labels, symbols and page references.

Two ways to work

Use a wide table for a quick time-series or panel analysis. Use the tidy table when selecting variables programmatically or joining observations to their source metadata. The wide and long formats repeat the same underlying values; their row counts should not be added.

Definitions travel with the data

The metadata folder contains a variable dictionary, population definitions, source index, raw-to-analytic mapping, release counts and generated checks. The inputs folder preserves the transcribed observations used to build the release.

Reading the accounts correctly

Measure or issue	Interpretation
Geography and banks	The aggregate covers active joint-stock banks in Bohemia, Moravia and Silesia. It is not a census of all Czechoslovak financial institutions.
Units and dates	Core accounts are nominal millions of Kč. National-roster columns explicitly retain thousands. Balance sheets are year-end stocks; income accounts are annual flows.
Published capital	Paid capital plus the explicitly published reserve line. Hidden reserves, pension and earmarked funds are not automatically included.
Lending-related claims	Loans and bills can include bank and correspondent claims. They do not identify domestic nonfinancial customer credit alone.
Bank creditors and deposits	Bank-panel general creditors are not interbank liabilities alone. Source deposit categories differ across institutions.
Income ratios	Annual income divided by end-year assets measures income intensity, rather than a conventional net interest margin.
Missing observations	Blanks remain missing. Source zero, derived zero and accepted national-roster treatment of a dash are distinguished in the metadata.

Two visible comparability breaks

1919: the reported creditor/deposit category includes bank creditors that cannot be separated. The comparable deposits field is blank, while the original reported total is retained.

1936: the aggregate income account covers 22 banks against 23 balance sheets. Income-to-assets ratios are withheld for this year. Matching counts elsewhere do not establish identical membership.

Source exceptions remain visible

Moravská banka has a 20 million Kč asset-component discrepancy in 1933. The printed total and the discrepancy are both preserved. The handbook is identified as the consulted digital retyping. The 1929 crosswalk measures a dated footprint, not later League asset coverage.

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Examples of questions the data can support

How did banking scale and composition change across the 1920s and 1930s? Which banks expanded during recovery? How much did capital ratios change within institutions? Did lending, deposits and earnings return at the same pace? Which results depend on a published accounting category or a price concept?

The observations establish balance-sheet and income patterns. Identifying credit supply, borrower demand or policy effects requires an additional research design.

A short Python example

```
import pandas as pd
r = pd.read_csv('data/annual_ratios.csv')
r[['year', 'capital_assets_pct',
   'loans_bills_assets_pct']].set_index('year').plot()
```

Rebuild the data from the frozen inputs

```
python code/build_dataset.py
```

The data transformation is offline and independent of the workbook renderer. The guide and figure builder uses pandas, matplotlib and reportlab. Read README.txt for file conventions and examples in Python, R and Stata.

Sources

League of Nations commercial-banking volumes (1931, 1934, 1935, 1938 and 1939); the national statistical handbook (1932, 1929 bank roster); Kašpar's contemporary bank handbook (1938, consulted digital retyping); National Bank reports and the retained CPI research supplement. Exact publications, pages, original units and source identifiers are in metadata/source_index.csv and the observation records.

Citation

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Public release and reuse

The dataset page is available at adamdittrich.github.io/czechoslovak-commercial-banking.html. Cite the version and retain the underlying source references. No additional reuse licence or DOI is assigned. Source publications and software retain their own terms.